

Zach Zukowski

Orlando, FL | Zach@Tokenization.Systems | 407-536-8625

[Tokenization.Systems](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [SSRN](#)

BLOCKCHAIN PAYMENTS PRODUCT · TOKENIZATION PLATFORM · STABLECOIN RESEARCH

Sourced LayerZero seed (~80x) · 250 investments · ~\$500M AUM · 8 SSRN papers · 8 federal comment letters

SUMMARY

Blockchain payments product and tokenization platform strategist. Founding research hire at Borderless Capital (RIA, Dec 2019 to Feb 2026): sourced the LayerZero seed round (~80x return; thesis preceded the firm's Cross-Chain Ecosystem Fund by two years); predicted Thorchain's \$200M insolvency 13 months in advance via 10-step scenario modeling (Dec 2023 internal memo; failure materialized in Jan 2025), underwriting the firm's no-exposure position. Now founder of Tokenization Systems (Feb 2026 to present), an independent research and partner-engagement program. Authored an eight-paper SSRN research program: Control Layer Intensity Index (CLII) for stablecoin gateway and payment-rail concentration; Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack (MVEP) for institutional tokenization diligence; programmable monetary-policy design (Adaptive Tokenomics); governance concentration; operational risk in token economies. Contributed eight comment letters across federal regulatory dockets (OCC bank stablecoin engagement; Treasury GENIUS Act state similarity; FDIC payment-stablecoin reserves and subsidiary issuance; FinCEN AML/CFT and PPSI sanctions; joint banking AML/CFT). Capital-markets infrastructure dialogues with Circle and Ubyx on stablecoin and deposit-token deployment.

EXPERIENCE

Founder · Tokenization Systems

Feb 2026 – Present

- Authored an eight-paper SSRN-live research program covering the [Control Layer Intensity Index](#) (CLII) for stablecoin gateway and payment-rail concentration, the [Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack](#) (MVEP) for institutional tokenization diligence, programmable monetary-policy design ([Adaptive Tokenomics](#)), governance concentration, and operational risk in token economies.
- Contributed eight comment letters across a federal regulatory program (OCC bank stablecoin engagement [RIN 1557-AF41](#) plus [supplemental control-layer extension](#); Treasury GENIUS Act state similarity; FDIC payment-stablecoin reserve standards [RIN 3064-AG19](#) and stablecoin-subsidary issuance approvals [RIN 3064-AG20](#); FinCEN AML/CFT [FINCEN-2026-0034](#); FinCEN-OFAC PPSI sanctions [FINCEN-2026-0100](#); joint banking AML/CFT [91 FR 18304](#)); [Routing the Dollar](#) submitted to the Federal Reserve Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (Jun 2026); [Governance Concentration](#) in peer review at Frontiers in Blockchain.
- Capital-markets infrastructure dialogues with Circle and Ubyx on stablecoin and deposit-token deployment.

Senior Investment Analyst, Digital Assets · Borderless Capital (RIA; first hire)

Dec 2019 – Feb 2026

- Predicted Thorchain's **\$200M insolvency 13 months in advance**; Borderless held no exposure when the predicted failure mode materialized.
- Sourced the **LayerZero seed round** investment for Borderless, returning ~80x; the underlying cross-chain interoperability thesis preceded the firm's Cross-Chain Ecosystem Fund by two years.
- Identified ~15% misreporting of circulating supply in a top-25 Layer 1 protocol by independently modeling its tokenomics (emission schedule, vesting, burn dynamics); the discrepancy had propagated to CoinMarketCap and CoinGecko, and was corrected after partnering with the protocol's foundation engineers.
- Prevented hostile governance capture on a top-25 blockchain via voting-path simulation under coalition-attack scenarios; surfaced the vulnerability and mitigation route before exploitation.
- Led discovery and diligence across a 1,000+ deal investment funnel (pre-seed to Series C); shipped 250 portfolio investments at ~25% deployment rate across ~10 institutional funds (~\$500M AUM), with build/partner/hold recommendations to committee.
- Advised 100 portfolio companies 1-on-1 on token mechanism design (stablecoin reserves, governance-token allocation and incentive design, yield wrappers, burn/emission dynamics); standards defined in [Introduction to Tokenomics](#).
- Built quantitative token-economic models forecasting emissions, fee capture, subsidy-to-revenue trajectories, and governance concentration under wide scenario ranges; supply-equilibrium and slashing dynamics supporting Layer 1 mechanism-design advisory.
- Translated regulatory change (GENIUS, CLARITY, Singapore MAS, MiCA, state money-transmitter and trust-charter regimes) into product, reserve, routing, and compliance decisions across U.S., Singapore, Cayman / BVI / Bermuda, and EU; coordinated cross-functional partner work spanning Product / Engineering, Risk (operational-risk taxonomy), and Legal.
- Mapped jurisdictional tax / regulatory advantages of DAT structures over direct crypto holding: Japan's Metaplanet DAT cuts crypto capital-gains tax from up to 55% to 20% (equity rate, further reducible via Japan's IRA structure); Hong Kong's Southbound Connect could give mainland Chinese capital regulated access to crypto banned domestically.

SELECTED RESEARCH

- [Routing the Dollar](#). Submitted to Federal Reserve / FRBNY Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (Jun 2026). Gateway concentration; CLII across 19 gateways including Visa Direct-adjacent paths.
- [Three Tokenization Strategies](#). Each of three strategies satisfies different MVEP categories with measurably different strength (Regulated Collateral Circuit, Multi-Issuer Yield Stack, Tokenized Equity Rails); Securitize as cross-strategy concentration risk.
- [Seven Dollars](#). Cross-product framework for major dollar-denominated digital products; CLII / MVEP decoupling; stress propagation through dependency chains (SVB, Circle pool, Paxos).
- [Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack](#). Ten-category institutional diligence standard; finds bank-chartered stablecoin issuers face ~22x the regulatory capital requirements of money-transmitter-chartered issuers at \$40B scale.
- [Adaptive Tokenomics](#). Industrial control engineering (PID controller) applied to token-supply emission as programmable monetary-policy mechanism; 240-scenario Monte Carlo simulation; cuts worst-case supply volatility ~6x under competitor-shock attack.
- [Operational Risk in Token Economies](#). Operational-risk taxonomy (74 risk vectors, 64 testable controls, 31 program objectives) mapped to a 624-scenario battery; Lido V3 staking-vault case study with custody and reporting controls relevant to tokenized payment platforms.
- [Governance Concentration Beyond Token Allocation](#). In peer review at Frontiers in Blockchain. 40-protocol cross-section: initial token allocation does not predict governance concentration; protocol sector does (DePIN significantly more concentrated than DeFi; Cohen's $d = 0.96$).
- [Who Burns the Tokens?](#) Burn-mechanism design (carrier contracts vs. subscriptions) drives demand concentration: Helium's carrier-contract model concentrates ~90% of token burns in 5 purchasers (HHI 0.22) despite ~1M hotspots; coalition-power analysis extends standard concentration measures for single-address risk.

TECHNICAL

Methods: policy-shock impact estimation (difference-in-differences), Monte Carlo simulation, PID controller design (industrial control engineering), coalition-power analysis, supply equilibrium modeling, build-versus-partner framework design

Data: Dune Analytics, Nansen Pro, Artemis, DefiLlama, CoinGecko, Helius (Solana), Spacescope, Blockscout, Token Terminal; automated SEC filing and press release monitoring + data extraction

Stack: Python (pandas, statsmodels, scipy, matplotlib), R (fixest, did, synthdid), SQL (DuneSQL, Trino), JavaScript / TypeScript; 14 custom Python MCP servers (FRED, DefiLlama, CoinGecko, Helius, Blockscout, Tally, Dune, Spacescope, Nansen, GitHub) for real-time feeds; Claude.ai + Claude Code + Cursor with 36-skill library and 17-file living-knowledge architecture; n8n, Apify, Git / GitHub

RECOGNITION

- Uniswap Foundation governance committee (2024)
- ETHDenver pitch judge
- [Introduction to Tokenomics](#) article publicly endorsed by Binance founder CZ on day of publication

EDUCATION

High Point University | B.S.B.A., Business Administration (Magna Cum Laude) · Investment Club President
Lingnan University, Hong Kong (Exchange)

2018